



Department of Political Science

SK2212 The Quality of Government in Comparative Perspective

Course Guide

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1. Introduction

This course explores problems of the quality of government (QoG) and corruption in a comparative perspective. The background to this is the recent consensus among social scientists about the importance of high-quality government for economic and democratic development as well as for social and environmental sustainability. Government organizations that are trustworthy, reliable, impartial, uncorrupted and competent are currently seen as one of the most important determinants of human well-being. Until recently the "general wisdom" was that corruption and related phenomena (patronage, clientelism and cronyism) had many positive effects ("greasing the wheels"). New theories and better data have turned this argument around. Corruption is now seen as having detrimental effects on economic growth, public goods provision, the viability of democratic processes and trust among citizens. Quality of government is not a problem of developing countries only, but exists also in economically advanced democracies where trust in government institutions and the sustainability of welfare programs have been questioned. The central issues that will be addressed in the course are: What is QoG? How can QoG be defined and measured? What do you get from high QoG and what are the mechanisms through which the effects of high/low QoG work? What explains the great variation between countries in QoG? How is QoG related to democracy, economic growth, the rule of law, social capital, inequality, social policies, and people's collective and individual well-being? Lastly, for those who aspire to win the Nobel prize: What does it take for countries to change from low to high quality of government institutions?

2. Learning Outcomes

At the end of the course the students are expected to be able to:

- Demonstrate in-depth knowledge of the concept of the quality of government, and distinguish it from related concepts
- Demonstrate in-depth knowledge of advanced theoretical frameworks showing the impact of the high/low quality government on human development
- Critically evaluate and compare advanced theoretical frameworks, as well as their methodological implications, showing the impact of high/low quality of government on human development and other valuable social outcomes
- Review and critically assess empirical findings from the literature
- Critically evaluate theoretical frameworks and empirical findings to identify contradictions and under-researched areas
- Critically use existing theoretical frameworks to analyze empirical cases
- Independently prepare an original piece of research about some central aspects of the QoG research agenda, based on a critical assessment of the literature
- Independently produce a text in accordance with the academic writing requirements
- Effectively communicate complex ideas to academic audiences

3. Teachers

Mattias Agerberg
Stephen Dawson
Victor Lapuente
Georgios Xezonakis

The QoG Institute, Department of Political Science (MN)
The QoG Institute, Department of Political Science (MA)
The QoG Institute, Department of Political Science (VL)
The QoG Institute, Department of Political Science (GX)

4. Organization of the Course

The course consists of lectures, compulsory seminars, individual tutorials and three written assignments.

Lectures address one of the three overarching questions of the course: What is QoG? How do you get QoG? How to move from a low-QoG equilibrium to a high-QoG equilibrium? Lectures give an overview of the main findings from relevant literatures.

Seminars take place in groups, which are formed after the course administration has the complete list of participants. There are six seminars in total.

Seminars 1-5 are discussions based on the assigned readings for each block of lectures (see the literature list below). The last seminar is where students present their final paper. The organization of the seminars will be discussed during the introductory lecture.

Students are required to read all readings as both the seminar discussions and the written assignments require familiarity with the substantive arguments of the papers/book chapters.

Attendance of the seminars is compulsory. Students who miss a seminar have to present a written memo (similar to the compensatory work for assignment 1, see below) of the literature assigned for the seminar. The minimum word count of the compensatory memo is 1,500 words. The compensatory work is to be uploaded onto Canvas (folder “Seminars: compensatory work”) and emailed to the relevant seminar tutor.

Individual Tutorials. Students may address the seminar tutors by appointment with specific queries regarding the content of the substantive seminars and to discuss their ideas for the final paper.

5. Assignments

There are three assignments: the memo, take-home exam and final paper. Each assignment is graded on a 0-7 scale: 0-2=Fail (U); 3-5=Pass (G); 6-7=High Pass (VG). All assignments are checked for plagiarism.

In order to pass the course students must reach a pass mark on each of the assignments and on the compensatory work, if they missed the compulsory seminars.

To achieve a high pass (VG), the arithmetic average of the assignments must be 5.5 or higher. Each assignment has a weight in the final grade: memo is 10%, take-home exam is 40% and final paper is 50%.

Assignment 1: Memo

The goal of the assignment is to write a short critical essay “What is quality of government (QoG)? and how the concept of QoG is different from the concept of good governance”?

The memo shall be uploaded onto Canvas no later than **February 05th, 2025, 17:00**. Queries about the memo shall be addressed to the relevant seminar tutor.

Detailed instructions for the memo can be found at the end of the course guide.

Assignment 2: Take-home exam

Take-home exam has two questions. Students are required to answer both questions.

In order to get a Pass for the take-home exam, students must get a pass grade (at least 3 points) for each question.

The exam questions will be posted on Canvas on **February 24, 2025 at 09:00am**. The answers shall be uploaded onto Canvas (2 individual folders, one per question) on **February 25 before 17:00**.

Stephen Dawson can be addressed with queries about the take-home exam.

Detailed instructions for the take-home exam can be found at the end of the course guide.

Exam Retake

Questions will be posted on Canvas in April 2025. Please check the schedule and the Canvas page for further information.

Assignment 3: Final Paper

The final paper is a research proposal about an under-researched issue in the QoG literature.

The final paper shall be uploaded onto Canvas on **March 21, 2025 before 17:00**.

Queries about the final paper shall be addressed to Georgios Xezonakis and Stephen

Dawson.

Detailed instructions for the final paper can be found at the end of the course guide.

Late submissions

All submissions for missed seminars and/or failed short and final paper shall be upload into Canvas no later than **April 24, 2025**.

Academic Writing

Throughout your time at University, you will write a number of academic texts (such as analytical papers and literature reviews, home exams and the final thesis). What follows are some of the basic principles for independent academic writing:

- Academic writing is based on the principle of clarity and transparency regarding the origin of the information and knowledge conveyed by the text.
- Academic texts are characterized by independent and self-designed writing.
- In combination, the above principles mean that in academic writing we use the ideas, thoughts, arguments, opinions, conclusions of others, but we make clear the origin of these by quoting and referring. We communicate with, build on, and credit previous research, authors, sources, but we do not copy them! Copying is plagiarism, which is the same as cheating.
- Some examples of plagiarism: 1) Copying an existing text. 2) Moving and deleting a few words from an existing text, 3) Translating an existing text from another language. Please note that none of these examples qualify as legitimate academic writing regardless of whether a reference is present or if the text is presented as one's own description and / or analysis.
- There should be no doubt whatsoever in the text about which ideas, thoughts, arguments, opinions and conclusions are yours (absent a reference) and which arguments you obtained from other texts (reference to the author included). There are different reference styles (see more about this at <http://www.ub.gu.se/skriva/referensstilar/>) but a good rule of thumb, for maximum transparency, is to include the reference in the text in the following form author surname, year, page, i.e. Sikkink 2000: 13.
- When an author you read uses particular wording to describe something, and you wish to use this exact wording in your text, this wording should be marked as a quote, with a reference that includes a page reference, such as (author surname, year, page). As stated, always including page numbers in the references in the text – whether cited or not – is a good rule of thumb!
- To put it simply, you avoid plagiarism by 1) writing independently (never ‘copy and paste’), 2) quoting, and 3) careful and frequent use of references.
- The Department of Political Science uses the Urkund control system against plagiarism. Our teachers are also very good at detecting texts that are not self-authored through our own critical reading experience. We are obliged to report suspicion of cheating to the Disciplinary Board at GU. Cheating can result in a warning or even a suspension from education.

Additional information and knowledge on ‘Searching and citing,’ ‘Plagiarism,’ ‘Language support’ and a web-course on ‘Academic integrity’ is available at UoG:s student portal. In fact, all

the necessary information is gathered at student portal > student environment & rules > disciplinary matters.

Attempts to deceive during examinations

An attempt to deceive during examinations means that a student has attempted to give an impression of their performance in a written exam or some of form of assessment that is not true. That is what is commonly referred to as cheating, or attempting to cheat. There are different kinds of attempts to deceive, such as plagiarism, prohibited aids and prohibited collaboration. Deception can also take other forms.

- **Plagiarism** means that a student has presented someone else's text or other material as if it were their own text or material.
- **Prohibited aid** means that a student has used aids, including AI, that were not permitted according to the instructions.
- **Prohibited collaboration** means that students have collaborated with each other in breach of the instructions.

Plagiarism: Copying material from the Internet, from books, journals, reports, or from a fellow student and then presenting it as one's own is strictly forbidden! Plagiarism is theft of someone else's work and will result in immediate fail of the assignment. Please note that the inclusion of a source in a bibliography list is not in itself sufficient attribution of another's work. In addition, unless it is a proper citation with a reference, any direct copying of text is forbidden. All submitted student work is screened with a program called *Ouriginal*, which compares a student's written work with published materials (including everything published on the internet) and all the work from prior students, to detect plagiarism. The material you have read and based your arguments and factual statements on should always be referenced using proper referencing technique. More information on references and how to avoid plagiarism can be found here:

<https://studentportal.gu.se/english/help-and-guidance/search-read-write/reference-management-and-plagiarism>

Prohibited aid: All your submitted texts should be your own original writing, and not written by someone else or generated by AI. Unless there are specific instructions for the use of AI for an assignment, it should not be used and presented as your own text. The use of any tools to cheat during on campus exams (e.g. DISA) is also strictly forbidden.

Prohibited collaboration: students can discuss their work, but individual submissions must be your own original writing, and hence not too similar the work of others. Be extra careful to avoid using common notes from such collaborations.

Any kind of cheating on examinations is considered a serious offence. Proved or suspected cheating will be reported to the Disciplinary Committee of the University of Gothenburg, in accordance with the procedure of disciplinary matters at the department of political science.

The consequences may be severe for a student if found guilty. A student may be suspended from classes and campus for a determined time-period (from 3 weeks to half a year), which will result in a temporary suspension of all financial aid (including CSN) and may jeopardize a student's residence permit status. More information on disciplinary matters, including plagiarism and its consequences, can be found here: <https://studentportal.gu.se/english/study-environment-and-rules/disciplinary-matters/>

Equal Treatment

The University of Gothenburg aims to promote equal rights and opportunities for students and employees and to combat discrimination related to gender, gender identity or gender expressions, ethnicity, religion or other beliefs, sexual orientation, disability or age. If, however, you as a student at the Department of Political Science become subject to such acts and actions, we encourage you to contact us to enable the opportunity for appropriate action. You can contact: the course coordinator, director of studies Ulrika Möller, equal treatment representative Birgitta Niklasson, or student counselor Eva Nilsson. Student counselors have confidentiality. You can also turn to these people if you experience problems or discomfort in the study environment, even if this is not directly aimed at you. All necessary contact information is available on our website.

6. Schedule

The schedule is available at the Canvas's course page

<https://cloud.timeedit.net/gu/web/schema/ri1X5002Z0101vQQ5wZ6779Y09yY5Y27QQ.html>

Please check the Canvas page regularly during the course.

6. Literature List

All readings are available online through the University's subscription or will be uploaded onto Canvas.

For the entire course

Bågenholm, A., Bauhr, M., Grimes, M and B. Rothstein, Bo. 2021. *Oxford Handbook of the Quality of Government*. Chicago University Press. (available online through GU library).

Recommended:

The webpage of the Quality of Government Institute (<http://www.qog.pol.gu.se>), where QoG-related data and publications can be found.

What is Quality of Government?

Rothstein, Bo. 2021. Quality of Government: Theory and Conceptualization. In Bågenholm, Bauhr, Grimes and Rothstein (eds.) *The Oxford Handbook of the Quality of Government*. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Pp. 3-24.

Rothstein, Bo and Jan Teorell. 2008. What is Quality of Government: A Theory of Impartial Political Institutions, *Governance* 21(2):165-190.

Agnafors, Marcus. 2013. Quality of Government: Toward a More Complex Definition, *American Political Science Review* 107(3): 433-445.

Sparling, Robert Alan. 2017. Impartiality and the Definition of Corruption, *Political Studies* 66(2): 376-391.

QoG: What do you get?

Nistotskaya, Marina. 2020. Quality of Government (QoG) as Impartiality: Review of the literature on causes and consequences of QoG, [KIPA \(Korean Institute of Public Administration\) Public Policy Review 1: 25-49](#).

Ahlerup, Pelle, Thushyanthan Baskaran, and Arne Bigsten. 2016. Government impartiality and sustained growth in Sub-Saharan Africa. *World Development* 83: 54-69.

Agerberg, Mattias. 2017. Failed expectations: Quality of government and support for populist parties in Europe, *European Journal of Political Research* 56(3): 578-600.

Recommended:

<https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/full/10.1111/padm.12945>

Structural explanations 1: Geography, History, Colonialism, Institutional Persistence and QoG

Hibbs, Douglas and Ola Olsson. 2004. Geography, Biogeography, and Why Some Countries are Rich and Others are Poor, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 101(10): 3715-3720.

Acemoglu, Daron, Johnson, Simon and James Robinson. 2002. Reversal of Fortune: Geography and Institutions in the Making of Modern World Income Distribution, *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 117(4): 1231-1294.

Becker, Sascha O., Katrin Boeckh, Christa Hainz, and Ludger Woessmann. 2016. The empire is dead, long live the empire! Long-run persistence of trust and corruption in the bureaucracy, *The Economic Journal* 126(590): 40-74.

Nunn, Nathan, and Leonard Wantchekon. 2011. The Slave Trade and the Origins of Mistrust in Africa, *American Economic Review* 101 (7): 3221-52.

Dell, Melissa. 2010. The Persistent Effects of Peru's Mining Mita, *Econometrica* 78(6): 1863-1903

Recommended:

Sachs, Jeffrey. 2003. Institutions don't rule: direct effects of geography on per capita income, National Bureau of Economic Research, *NBER Working papers series* No. w9490.
https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w9490/w9490.pdf

Structural explanations 2: Economic Structure and QoG

Economic structure and QoG

Olander, Petrus. 2019. Diversification, Homogeneity of Interests, and the Impartiality of Government. In Bågenholm, Bauhr, Grimes and Rothstein (eds.) *The Oxford Handbook of the Quality of Government*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, pp. 378-398.

Gawande, By Kishore, Pravin Krishna, and Marcelo Olarreaga. 2012. Lobbying Competition over Trade Policy, *International Economic Review* 53(1): 115-132.

Resource curse and QoG

Mehlum, Halvor, Karl Moene and Ragnar Torvik. 2006. Institutions and the Resource Curse, *Economic Journal* 115 (508): 1-20.

Sachs, Jeffrey and Andrew Warner. 2001. The Curse of Natural Resources. *European Economic Review* 45: 827-838.

Recommended:

Madison, J. 1788. The federalist papers No. 51. <https://billofrightsinstitute.org/primary-sources/federalist-no-51>

Venables, Anthony. 2016. Using Natural Resources for Development: Why Has It Proven So Difficult? *Journal of Economic Perspectives* 30(1): 161–184.

Democracy and QoG

Miller, Gary and Thomas Hammond. 1994. Why Politics is More Fundamental than Economics: Incentive-Compatible Mechanisms Are Not Credible, *Journal of Theoretical Politics* 6 (1): 5-26.

Olson Mancur. 1993. Dictatorship, Democracy, and Development, *American Political Science Review* 87(3): 567-576.

Keefer, Philip. 2007. Clientelism, Credibility, and the Policy Choices of Young Democracies, *American Journal of Political Science* 51(3): 433-448.

Bauhr, Monika and Marcia Grimes. Democracy and the Quality of Government. In Bågenholm, Bauhr, Grimes and Rothstein (eds.) *The Oxford Handbook of the Quality of Government*. Oxford: OUP, p. 181-208.

Recommended:

Charron, Nicholas and Victor Lapuente. 2010. Does Democracy Produce Quality of Government? *European Journal of Political Research* 49(4): 443-470.

Falaschetti, Dino and Gary Miller. 2001. Constraining Leviathan: Moral Hazard and Credible Commitment in Constitutional Design, *Journal of Theoretical Politics* 13(4): 389-411.

Bureaucracy and QoG

Oliveira, E., Abner, G., Lee, S., Suzuki, K., Hur, H., & Perry, J. L. 2023. What does the evidence tell us about merit principles and government performance? *Public Administration*, <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/full/10.1111/padm.12945>

Nistotskaya, Marina and Luciana Cingolani. 2016. Bureaucratic Structure, Regulatory Quality and Entrepreneurship in a Comparative Perspective: Cross-Sectional and Panel Data Evidence, *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory* 26(3): 519-534

Oliveros, Virginia, and Christian Schuster. 2018. Merit, Tenure, and Bureaucratic Behavior: Evidence from a Conjoint Experiment in the Dominican Republic, *Comparative Political Studies* 51(6): 759–92.

Boräng, Frida, Cornell Agnes, Grimes, Marcia and Christian Schuster. 2018. Cooking the books: Bureaucratic politicization and policy knowledge, *Governance* 31: 7–26.

Decentralization and QoG

Prud'homme, R. 1995. The Dangers of Decentralization, *The World Bank Observer* 10(2): 201-20

Fisman, Raymond, and Roberta Gatti. 2002. Decentralization and Corruption: Evidence Across Countries, *Journal of Public Economics* 83(3): 325-345.

Faguet, J-P. 2014. Decentralization and Governance, *World Development* 53:2-13

Smoke, P. 2015. Rethinking Decentralization: Assessing Challenges to a Popular Public Sector Reform, *Public Administration and Development* 35:97-112

Kyriacou, Andreas and Oriol Roca-Sagalés. 2011. Fiscal and Political Decentralization and Government Quality, *Environment and Planning C* 29: 204-223

Oto-Peralias, Daniel, Romero-Avila, Diego and Carlos Usabiaga. 2013. Does Fiscal Decentralization Mitigate the Effects of Corruption on Public Deficits? *European Journal of Political Economy* 32: 205-231

Recommended:

Oates, W. 1999. An Essay on Fiscal Federalism, *Journal of Economic Literature* 37(3): 1120-1149.

Faguet J-P. and F. Sanchez. 2008. Decentralization's Effects on Educational Outcomes in Bolivia and Colombia, *World Development* 36(7): 1294–1316.

Arends, Helge. 2020. The Dangers of Fiscal Decentralization and Public Service Delivery: a Review of Arguments, *German Political Science Quarterly (Politische Vierteljahresschrift)* 61: 599-622. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11615-020-00233-7>

Corruption: Theoretical Perspectives

Persson, Anna, Bo Rothstein and Jan Teorell. 2013. Why Anticorruption Reforms Fail: Systemic Corruption as a Collective Action Problem, *Governance* 26(3): 449-471.

Rothstein, Bo. 2011. Anti-corruption: the indirect 'big bang' approach. *Review of International Political Economy* 18(2): 228-250.

Khan, M., Andreoni, A., & Roy, P. 2019. Anti-corruption in adverse contexts: strategies for improving implementation. SOAS-Anti Corruption Evidence *Working paper 13*, [https://eprints.soas.ac.uk/23495/1/Anti-Corruption%20in%20Adverse%20Contexts%20\(1\).pdf](https://eprints.soas.ac.uk/23495/1/Anti-Corruption%20in%20Adverse%20Contexts%20(1).pdf)

Pyman, M. & Heywood, P. (2020). The sector focus and reformulation approach (SFRA). *Global Integrity - ACE Working Paper 5*. https://ca-anticorruption.com/wp-content/uploads/2020/12/The-Sector-FocusReformulation-Approach-_compressed-1.pdf

The World Bank. 2012. *Fighting Corruption in Public Services: Chronicling Georgia's Reforms* (available on Canvas)

Recommended:

Prasad, Monica, Mariana Borges and Andre Nickow. 2019. Approaches to Corruption: a Synthesis of the Scholarship, *Studies in Comparative International Development* 54: 96-132.

Corruption: Empirical Research on Corruption

Keefer, Philip. 2007. Clientelism, Credibility, and the Policy Choices of Young Democracies, *American Journal of Political Science* 51(4): 804-21.

Olken, Benjamin. 2007. Monitoring Corruption: Evidence from a Field Experiment in Indonesia, *Journal of Political Economy* 115 (2): 200-249.

Cameron, Lisa, Ananish Chaudhuri, Nisvan Erkal and Lata Gangadharan. 2009. Propensities to Engage in and Punish Corrupt Behavior: Experimental Evidence from Australia, India, Indonesia and Singapore, *Journal of Public Economics* 93(7): 843-851.

Corbacho, Ana, Daniel Gingerich, Virginia Oliveros and Mauricio Ruiz-Vega. 2016. Corruption as a Self-Fulfilling Prophecy: Evidence from a Survey Experiment in Costa Rica *American Journal of Political Science* 60(4): 1077-1092

Recommended:

Knutsen, Carl Henrik, Andreas Kotsadam, Eivind Hammersmark Olsen and Tore Wig. 2017. Mining and Local Corruption in Africa, *American Journal of Political Science* 61(2): 320-334.

Bobonis, Gustavo, Luis R. Cámara Fuertes and Rainer Schwabe. 2016. Monitoring Corruptible Politicians, *American Economic Review* 106(8): 2371-405.

Assignment 1 (memo paper): instructions

The goal of the assignment is to write a short critical essay “What is quality of government (QoG)? and how the concept of QoG is different from the concept of good governance”?

The review shall contain the following elements:

1. Introduction: a short statement on how you understand QoG and how it is different from the concept of good governance. A sentence on how your essay is structured.
2. Main section: Discuss the concept of QoG in detail. Support your discussion with references to the course materials (for example, Agnafors (2013)’s critique of the original concept by Rothstein and Teorell (2012)) and real-word examples or counterfactuals (fictional scenarios).
3. Discuss how the concept of QoG is different from the concept of good governance, and why is it important to distinguish between the two.
4. Conclusion: summarize your main statements on QoG vs good governance.

Grading:

The grade will reflect the extent to which a correct understanding of the arguments presented in the literature is demonstrated; the ability to effectively explain both concepts using the reference the course materials, real word examples and/or counterfactuals; the ability to effectively explain the need to distinguish between the two concepts in question. The structure of the essay and the clarity of the language will also be considered. The assignment must be completed in a timely manner and to the required specifications (see section “Formalities” below).

The papers are graded on a 0-7 scale: 0-2 = Fail (U); 3-5 = Pass (G); 6-7 = High Pass (VG).

The weight of the assignment’s grade in the final grade is 10%.

Formalities:

- Max word count is 700 (including foot/end notes and in-text references, but excluding the reference list at the end of the memo).¹
- Line spacing: 1.5 lines.
- Font: size 12.
- The paper should be uploaded onto Canvas as a Word document, entitled “memo_student’s last name” (memo_Olsson).
- The following information must be on the first page of the memo: last name, first name, course name (SK2212), assignment (memo) and word count.

¹ Papers that exceed the maximum word count by more than 10% will not be graded; and those papers that exceed the maximum word count up to 10% will be penalized by the loss of one point from the assignment grade.

Assignment 2 (take-home exam): instructions

Take-home exam has two questions. Students are required to answer both questions. The exam questions will be posted on Canvas on **February 24, 2025 at 9 am**. The answers shall be uploaded onto Canvas (2 individual folders, one per question) before **17:00 on February 25, 2025**.

Grading:

The grade will reflect the extent to which a correct understanding of the arguments presented in the literature is demonstrated; the ability to clearly answer the questions using the course materials, real word example and/or counterfactuals; the ability to critically evaluate the strength of theoretical explanations and the empirical evidence provided in support of them. The structure of the essay and the clarity of the language will also be considered. The assignment must be completed in a timely manner and to the required specifications (see section “Formalities” below).

Each answer is graded on a 0-7 scale: 0-2 = Fail (U); 3-5 = Pass (G); 6-7 = High Pass (VG) and the grade for this assignment is computed as an arithmetic average of four answers.

In order to get a Pass for the take-home exam each answer must achieve a pass grade, that is at least 3 points.

The weight of the assignment’s grade in the final grade is 40%.

Formalities:

- Max word count is 800 words per question (including foot/end notes and in-text references, but excluding reference list at the end of the final paper).²
- Line spacing: 1.5 lines.
- Font: size 12.
- Answers should be uploaded as a Word document.
- Each answer should be uploaded onto a separate folder on Canvas (your answer to question 1 should be uploaded into the folder “Question 1”, your answer to question 2 should be uploaded into the folder “Question 2”).
- Don’t put your name or other information that can identify you in the document. For each uploaded answer Canvas will generate a unique ID number, making your answers anonymous for the graders.

² Answers that exceed the maximum word count by more than 10% will not be graded; and those answers that exceed the maximum word count up to 10% will be penalized by the loss of one point from the question grade.

Assignment 3 (final paper): instructions

The goal of the assignment is to write a research proposal on an under-researched issue in the QoG field.

The proposal shall contain the following elements:

1. Introduction: a presentation of a QoG-related problem you wish to investigate, including a justification as to why it is important both from academic and policy perspectives.
2. A critical discussion of the relevant literature(s) on the chosen problem, including major theoretical perspectives and most important empirical findings.
3. A presentation of limitations of the existing literature (for example, how the existing literature has under-researched or completely overlooked a certain issue/factor in the problem you are interested in).
4. A presentation of a specific research question stemming from the identified gap.
5. Conclusion: a brief discussion on how the existing literature would move our understanding of the problem forward if the identified gap is addressed successfully.

Synopsis:

Students are encouraged to email to their seminar tutors a short presentation (200 words max) of their ideas for the final paper (synopsis) two days before the individual tutorials.

Grading:

The grade will reflect the extent to which the presented overview of the existing literature on the chosen issue is comprehensive and cohesive; the ability to identify and effectively show limitations of a literature; to pose a relevant research question (stemming from the identified gap(s)), and to convincingly show the contribution that the intended research would make to the literature. The structure of the essay and the clarity of the language will also be considered. The assignment must be completed in a timely manner and to the required specifications (see section “Formalities” below).

The papers are graded on a 0-7 scale: 0-2 = Fail (U); 3-5 = Pass (G); 6-7 = High Pass (VG). The weight of the assignment’s grade in the final grade is 50% (15credits students only).

Formalities:

- Max word count is 3,500 (including foot/end notes and in-text references, but excluding reference list at the end of the final paper).³
- Line spacing: 1.5 lines.
- Font: size 12.
- The paper should be uploaded onto Canvas as Word document, entitled “FP_student’s last name” (FP_Olsson).
- The following information must be on the first page of each document you upload onto Canvas: last name, first name, course name (SK2212), assignment (final paper) and word count.

³ Papers that exceed the maximum word count by more than 10% will not be graded; and those papers that exceed the maximum word count up to 10% will be penalized by the loss of one point from the assignment grade.